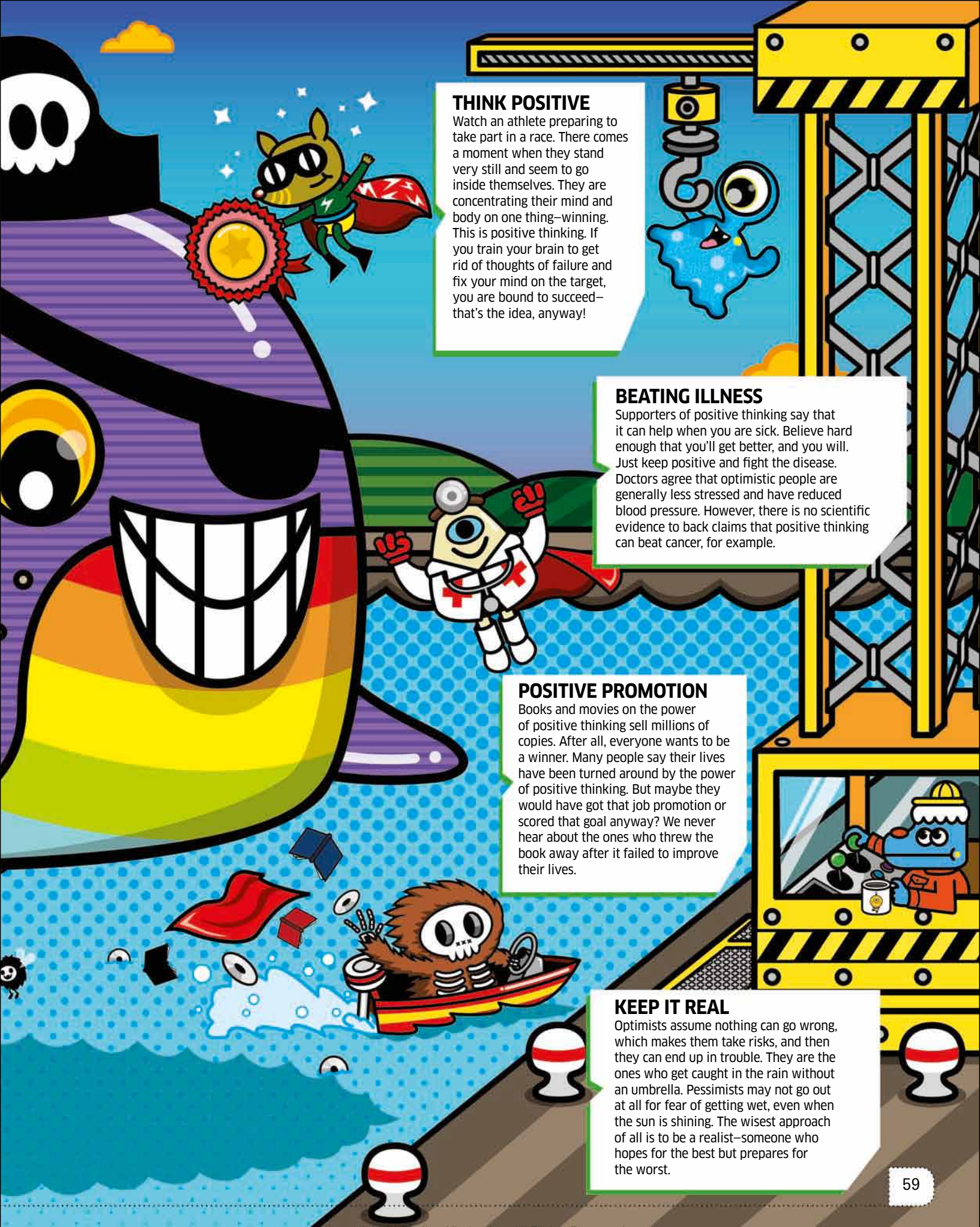




THINK POSITIVE

Watch an athlete preparing to take part in a race. There comes a moment when they stand very still and seem to go inside themselves. They are concentrating their mind and body on one thing—winning. This is positive thinking. If you train your brain to get rid of thoughts of failure and fix your mind on the target, you are bound to succeed—that's the idea, anyway!

BEATING ILLNESS

Supporters of positive thinking say that it can help when you are sick. Believe hard enough that you'll get better, and you will. Just keep positive and fight the disease. Doctors agree that optimistic people are generally less stressed and have reduced blood pressure. However, there is no scientific evidence to back claims that positive thinking can beat cancer, for example.

POSITIVE PROMOTION

Books and movies on the power of positive thinking sell millions of copies. After all, everyone wants to be a winner. Many people say their lives have been turned around by the power of positive thinking. But maybe they would have got that job promotion or scored that goal anyway? We never hear about the ones who threw the book away after it failed to improve their lives.

KEEP IT REAL

Optimists assume nothing can go wrong, which makes them take risks, and then they can end up in trouble. They are the ones who get caught in the rain without an umbrella. Pessimists may not go out at all for fear of getting wet, even when the sun is shining. The wisest approach of all is to be a realist—someone who hopes for the best but prepares for the worst.